

**AI discovers 4 new materials**

An AI tool, developed by researchers at the University of Liverpool discovers of four new materials. <https://digit.in/oct21-17>

**IBM next-gen power server**

IBM has announced a new Unix-based server, the IBM Power E1080. <https://digit.in/oct21-18>



PAPERBOY

Faster than print

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Imagine having all the newspapers across the length and breadth of India at your fingertips, ready for you early in the morning, on your smartphone, for free. That is what Paperboy is, and it benefits everyone, from the NRI who wants to read news from their hometown, to someone living in a remote area within the country, where the physical copies only reach in the afternoon. The app has itself grown organically, onboarding small publishers and building the tech necessary to deliver high quality content to low end devices over spotty internet connections. There are over a thousand epapers available through the app today. Users themselves have grown through word of mouth, and the app

has over one million installations on the Play Store. We spoke to Karthik Jonna, Co-founder and director of Paperboy on how the idea of the app came about, “A few years back a lot of students in my college were not able to read newspapers, and we were thinking what might be the reason. We figured out that none of us have enough time in the morning to sit down and read the newspaper, and then get ready for college. That is when we thought what can be done to address this particular issue. That is when we figured out a way where newspapers are delivered to the user’s devices every morning, then people can read it no matter where they are, or what they are doing. They can take out 10 minutes to go through the app, go through the newspapers and be done with it. That is how we thought about Paperboy.” Karthik’s dad also urged him to create a platform where regional language newspapers would be available easily on apps.

We then asked the process of getting newspapers on board the app.

Karthik says, “At first, we faced a lot of conservatism, or let us say that they were not keen on partnering with us. For the first six months, we had zero newspapers on board. We tried a lot, to partner with them, and convince them, but really nobody was interested, and we were trying to figure out why they were not coming on board. Finally a small kannada newspaper came on board, and we understood how to talk to the publishers, and we were approaching them the wrong way. We explained in clear terms, and within the next three months, we were able to onboard close to two hundred publications. Publishers agreed after seeing other papers on the platform, and it is all inbound now.”

We then asked the process of digitising all the small regional newspapers, and how the team went about doing that. Karthik says, “our team has visited 50 to 60 percent of all Indian districts. Most of these publications don’t even have a website. You have to go talk to them, and that is when things get converted. Initially